

# KBC Rainbow Project — Complete Interview Guide

Your project explained simply with examples + Ready to speak answers

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## PART 1 — UNDERSTAND YOUR PROJECT FIRST

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### Simple Story — What KBC Does and Why Your Team Exists

#### YOUR PROJECT STORY

KBC is a large European bank operating in multiple countries: Belgium (headquarters), Bulgaria, Hungary, Slovakia, and others.

As a bank, KBC must follow strict rules set by European banking regulators. These regulators need financial data from KBC regularly — daily, monthly — to make sure the bank is healthy and not taking too much risk.

Your team's job:  
Collect financial data from all KBC country branches,  
process and clean it through ETL pipelines,  
and deliver it to the right teams and regulators on time.

Think of it like this:  
You are the postal service of KBC's data.  
Data comes in from all countries.  
You sort it, clean it, package it correctly.  
Then deliver it to the right destination on time.  
If you are late — the bank gets penalized.

## PART 2 — THE DATA LAYERS EXPLAINED WITH EXAMPLE

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### Example: Bulgaria sends a customer account file today

Let's follow ONE file from Bulgaria through ALL layers so you understand each step.

#### Step 1 — File Arrives (Putty / SFTP)

#### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

Bulgaria's system automatically sends a file every morning at 6 AM.  
File name: BG\_ACCOUNTS\_20240115.csv  
It contains: 50,000 rows of customer account data

Fields: customer\_id, account\_number, balance, currency, account\_type, date

This file lands on a server.

You use Putty to connect to that server and check if it arrived.

Commands you run in Putty:

```
ls -lh /landing/bulgaria/      -- see if file is there
wc -l BG_ACCOUNTS_20240115.csv -- count rows (should be 50,000)
head -5 BG_ACCOUNTS_20240115.csv -- check first 5 rows look correct
tail -5 BG_ACCOUNTS_20240115.csv -- check last 5 rows
```

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Files from local country teams — Belgium, Bulgaria, Hungary, Slovakia — arrive daily via SFTP on our server.*

*I use Putty to connect and verify file arrival — checking file size, row count, and file structure before the ETL pipeline starts processing."*

## Step 2 — LANDING Layer

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

The file is received and stored exactly as Bulgaria sent it.

No changes. No processing.

Just safely parked in the Landing area.

Why? Because if something goes wrong later, you always have the original file to go back to.

Think of it like: You received a letter.

You put it in an inbox. You haven't opened it yet.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Landing layer is where files first arrive.*

*Data is stored raw — exactly as received from the source country.*

*No transformation happens here.*

*This ensures we always have the original source data for audit and recovery purposes."*

## Step 3 — STAGING Layer

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

Now the file data is loaded into database tables.

Still raw — exactly as Bulgaria sent it.

In staging table you might see:

customer\_id = 'BG001234'

balance = '1500,50' (comma instead of decimal — Bulgaria's format)

account\_type = 'SAV'

date = '15/01/2024' (DD/MM/YYYY — Bulgaria's date format)

These are raw values — not yet cleaned or standardized.

50,000 rows loaded into staging table.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Staging layer loads raw file data into database tables.*

Data is stored as-is — same format the source country sent.

This is the foundation for all downstream processing.

If ETL fails in later layers, we can restart from staging without re-ingesting the original file."

### Step 4 — INF Layer (Interface Layer — Informatica runs here)

#### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

THIS IS WHERE INFORMATICA POWERENTER WORKS.

Your ETL mappings process the staging data here.

What transformations happen:

1. Date format conversion (Expression transformation):

Bulgaria sends: 15/01/2024

Informatica converts to: 2024-01-15 (standard format)

2. Decimal format fix (Expression transformation):

Bulgaria sends: 1500,50 (comma as decimal)

Informatica converts to: 1500.50 (dot as decimal)

3. Currency standardization (Expression transformation):

Bulgaria sends amounts in Bulgarian Lev

Informatica converts to Euros using exchange rate lookup

4. NULL handling (Expression with NVL):

Some rows have empty account\_type

NVL(account\_type, 'UNKNOWN') fills it with default

5. Reference data enrichment (Lookup transformation):

customer\_id BG001234 looked up in customer master

Full customer name, segment, risk rating fetched

6. Data routing (Router transformation):  
Savings accounts go to one target table  
Current accounts go to another target table

Result: 50,000 rows cleaned, standardized, enriched.  
Loaded into IDL layer.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"INF is the Interface layer where Informatica PowerCenter processes data."*

This is where all transformations happen —  
date format standardization, decimal conversion, currency conversion,  
NULL handling, reference data lookup, and data routing.

For example — Bulgaria sends dates as DD/MM/YYYY and amounts with comma decimal.  
Expression transformations convert these to standard KBC group format.  
Lookup transformations enrich records with customer master data.  
Router transformations split records to appropriate target tables."

### Step 5 — IDL Layer (Integration Layer)

#### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

Now data from ALL countries arrives at this layer.  
Belgium data, Bulgaria data, Hungary data, Slovakia data.

IDL makes sure all country data follows EXACTLY the same format.

Example problem IDL solves:  
Belgium calls it: account\_category = 'SAVINGS'  
Bulgaria calls it: account\_type = 'SAV'  
Hungary calls it: prod\_type = 'S'

IDL standardizes all of these to: account\_type = 'SAVINGS'

Now all 4 countries' data looks identical in format.  
Ready to be combined.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"IDL is the Integration layer."*

Data from all country branches arrives here.  
IDL standardizes and harmonizes data across all countries —  
making sure Belgium, Bulgaria, Hungary, Slovakia data  
all follow the same KBC group data standards

before loading into the shared repository."

## Step 6 — SDM (Shared Data Mart) in Teradata

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

All clean, standardized data from all countries is now loaded into Teradata SDM.

SDM = the central library of KBC's data.  
All downstream teams access data from here.

Example: SDM has:  
500,000 customer account rows (from all countries combined)  
All in same format, all clean, all accurate.

Any team that needs customer data comes to SDM.  
GCRD team queries SDM for credit data.  
SRB reporting queries SDM for financial data.  
Local teams query SDM for their reports.

### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"SDM is the Shared Data Mart — stored in Teradata.*

This is the central repository where all clean, processed data lives.  
All downstream teams — GCRD, local reporting teams, regulatory teams — access data from SDM.  
Teradata was chosen because of its ability to handle large volumes of financial data efficiently."

## Step 7 — Local MDM (Master Data Management)

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

MDM = the most accurate, clean, official version of data.

Each country gets their own Local MDM:  
Bulgaria MDM = Bulgaria's clean master data  
Hungary MDM = Hungary's clean master data

Why do countries need their own MDM back?  
Because they need to use this clean data for their own local country regulatory submissions.

Example:  
Bulgaria sends raw data → your team cleans it →

cleaned data goes back to Bulgaria MDM →  
Bulgaria uses this clean version for their local reports.

#### 💡 SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Local MDM is each country's clean master data.  
After we process and standardize country data,  
the clean version goes back to each country's Local MDM.  
Countries use their Local MDM for their own  
country-level regulatory submissions."*

### Step 8 — Group MDM (Evening Run)

#### 📋 REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

Every evening — after all local MDMs are ready —  
Group MDM runs.

Group MDM combines ALL local MDMs:  
Belgium MDM + Bulgaria MDM + Hungary MDM + Slovakia MDM  
= Complete KBC Group picture

This is the FULL view of KBC as one organization.

COUNTERPARTY processing happens here:  
Group MDM identifies all counterparties —  
other banks, financial institutions that KBC deals with.

Example counterparty:  
KBC has lent 100 million euros to Deutsche Bank.  
Group MDM processes this counterparty exposure.  
This data is then sent to TALTA team.

#### 💡 SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Group MDM runs every evening after all Local MDMs complete.  
It combines all country data into a single KBC group-level view.  
Counterparty processing happens here —  
identifying and consolidating data about other banks  
and financial institutions that KBC deals with across all countries.  
The processed counterparty data is sent to the TALTA team  
for regulatory submission."*

## PART 3 — BUSINESS TERMS EXPLAINED WITH EXAMPLES

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## What is Counterparty?

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

KBC Belgium lends 100 million euros to Deutsche Bank Germany.  
Deutsche Bank = Counterparty (another bank KBC does business with).

Regulator asks KBC: 'If Deutsche Bank collapses tomorrow,  
how much money does KBC lose?'

KBC must answer: 'We have 100 million exposure to Deutsche Bank.'

Your ETL pipeline processes all counterparty data from all countries.  
Group MDM combines them.  
TALTA team submits to regulator.

Why daily? Because counterparty exposure changes daily.  
Today KBC lent more to Deutsche Bank.  
Tomorrow they got repaid partially.  
Regulator needs current picture every day.

### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Counterparty data is information about other banks and financial institutions  
that KBC deals with — lending, borrowing, trading."*

Our ETL pipeline collects counterparty data from all KBC country branches,  
processes it through Group MDM,  
and sends consolidated counterparty exposure data to the TALTA team.  
TALTA submits this to European banking regulators daily.

This data is critical because regulators use it to assess  
KBC's exposure to other financial institutions.  
If any counterparty fails, regulators need to know KBC's risk position immediately."

## What is RAY / GCRD?

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

GCRD = Group Credit Risk Data team.  
RAY = Risk Authority — the data process for credit risk.

What credit risk means:  
KBC has given loans to 10,000 customers and companies across all countries.  
Some customers might not repay their loans.  
How much total loss risk does KBC have?

Example:

KBC Belgium gave 500 million in loans.  
KBC Bulgaria gave 200 million in loans.  
KBC Hungary gave 150 million in loans.  
Total credit risk = 850 million.

Your team runs RAY process:  
Collects all loan and credit data from all countries.  
Processes and consolidates.  
Sends to GCRD team.

GCRD team calculates: KBC's total credit risk = 850 million.  
They report this to KBC management and regulators.

#### **SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW**

*"RAY is the Risk Authority data process.*

We collect credit data — loans, credit facilities — from all KBC country branches.

Process it through our ETL pipeline.

And send consolidated risk data to the GCRD — Group Credit Risk Data — team.

GCRD uses this to calculate KBC's total credit risk position across the group.

This feeds into regulatory risk reports and internal risk management decisions."

## What is Reconciliation?

### **REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST**

Monthly reconciliation — simple example:

KBC Bulgaria's accounting system says:  
Total customer deposits in Bulgaria = 500 million euros.

Your ETL data in Teradata says:  
Total customer deposits from Bulgaria = 498 million euros.

Difference = 2 million euros.

Reconciliation = finding WHY there is a 2 million difference.

Possible reasons:

1. 2 million in transactions happened after file was sent
2. Currency conversion rounding difference
3. Some accounts excluded by a filter that shouldn't be
4. Data processing error in ETL

Your team investigates, finds the reason, explains it.

If it is an ETL error — fix it.  
If it is a timing difference — document it as expected.

#### **SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW**

*"Monthly reconciliation validates that our ETL-processed data matches the source accounting systems in each country.*

For example — if Bulgaria's accounting system shows 500 million in deposits but our Teradata data shows 498 million, we investigate the 2 million gap.

We identify whether it is a timing difference, a currency conversion issue, or an actual ETL processing error.  
This ensures KBC's financial reporting is accurate and consistent."

## What is Gap Filling / CRCT?

#### **REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST**

Bulgaria sends their monthly credit file.  
50,000 rows. But 500 rows have empty 'credit\_rating' field.

Why empty? Maybe Bulgaria's system didn't have credit rating for those customers.

Gap filling = filling those 500 empty values.

How? Using these sources:

1. Previous month's credit rating for same customer
2. Central reference data from KBC group
3. Default value based on account type

CRCT = the process/system that handles this gap filling logic.

Why is this important?

If we send a report to regulator with 500 empty credit ratings — regulator rejects the report.  
Gap filling ensures data is complete before submission.

#### **SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW**

*"Gap filling handles incomplete data from local country branches.*

For example — if Bulgaria sends a file with some empty credit rating fields, the CRCT process fills those gaps using previous month's data,

group-level reference data, or business-defined default values.

This ensures regulatory reports are complete and accurate before submission — regulators reject incomplete submissions."

## What is SRB Reporting?

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

SRB = Single Resolution Board.

A European regulator based in Brussels.

Their job: If a bank is failing, how to close it safely without affecting millions of customers.

For this they need: Complete financial picture of every major European bank.

KBC must send SRB:

Asset data — what KBC owns (loans given, investments)

Liability data — what KBC owes (customer deposits, borrowings)

Capital data — KBC's own financial strength

Your ETL pipeline processes this data from all countries, consolidates at group level, and prepares SRB submission files.

What happens if delayed?

SRB sends formal regulatory notice to KBC.

KBC management must explain the delay.

Repeated delays = regulatory sanctions = huge fines.

### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"SRB — Single Resolution Board — is a European banking regulator.*

*They need complete financial data from KBC to assess the bank's resolvability — meaning if KBC ever faced a crisis, how it could be wound down safely.*

*Our ETL pipeline processes asset, liability, and capital data from all KBC country branches, consolidates at group level in Teradata, and prepares the SRB regulatory submission files."*

## What is ICM?

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

ICM = Internal Credit Market.

Example:

KBC Belgium has excess cash.

KBC Bulgaria needs cash for lending to customers.

KBC Belgium lends 50 million euros to KBC Bulgaria.

This is an INTERNAL transaction — within the KBC family.

Why does regulator care?

They need to understand how money flows within the KBC group.

If KBC Belgium lends too much to KBC Bulgaria —  
and Bulgaria has problems — Belgium is affected too.

Your ETL pipeline processes all these internal transactions  
and reports them.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"ICM — Internal Credit Market — tracks credit transactions  
between KBC group entities.*

For example — when KBC Belgium lends funds to KBC Bulgaria internally,  
this transaction is captured in ICM data.

Our ETL pipeline processes these internal transactions  
and reports them for regulatory purposes.

Regulators use ICM data to understand intra-group financial flows"

## PART 4 — TOOLS CONNECTION EXPLAINED

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### How Putty Connects

#### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

Putty = tool to connect to the SFTP server where files arrive.

Every morning your first task:

Open Putty → Connect to server → Check if all country files arrived.

Commands you use:

ls -lh /landing/belgium/      -- did Belgium file arrive?

ls -lh /landing/bulgaria/      -- did Bulgaria file arrive?

wc -l BG\_ACCOUNTS\_20240115.csv      -- how many rows?

head -3 BG\_ACCOUNTS\_20240115.csv      -- check file format correct?

If file not arrived → contact source country team immediately.  
This is a dependency — ETL cannot start without the file.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"I use Putty daily to connect to the SFTP landing server and verify file arrival from all country branches. I check file existence, size, row count, and structure before confirming ETL can proceed. If any file is missing, I immediately contact the source team because our batch jobs depend on these files arriving on time."*

## How Informatica PowerCenter Connects

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

After files are verified — Informatica batch jobs start.

What Informatica does:

1. Reads files from staging (Source Qualifier)
2. Applies all transformations (Expression, Lookup, Joiner, Router)
3. Loads clean data into Teradata tables (IDL, SDM, MDM)

When I get an enhancement request:

Example: Bulgaria starts sending a new field 'ESG\_SCORE'.

I open Informatica Designer.

Add the new column to the flat file source definition.

Add it to the Expression transformation.

Map it to the target table.

Test in dev environment.

Move to production.

When a mapping fails:

I open Workflow Monitor.

Find the failed session.

Check session log — which row, which transformation caused failure.

Identify root cause — NULL in mandatory field? DB space? Bad record?

Fix and restart.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Informatica PowerCenter is the core ETL engine. It reads data from staging, applies all transformation logic, and loads processed data into Teradata."*

For enhancements — I work in Informatica Designer:  
modifying flat file source definitions, updating transformation logic,  
adding new fields through the mapping, and mapping to target tables.

For failures — I use Workflow Monitor to check session logs,  
identify which transformation failed and why,  
then fix and restart the mapping."

## How PostgreSQL Connects

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

PostgreSQL stores job dependency and runtime information.

Think of it like this:

Each batch job has rules about when it can run.

Job B can only run AFTER Job A completes successfully.

These dependency rules are stored in PostgreSQL.

When you investigate: 'Why didn't Group MDM run tonight?'

You query PostgreSQL:

```
SELECT job_name, status, start_time, end_time  
FROM job_runtime WHERE run_date = '2024-01-15';
```

This shows: 'Local MDM for Bulgaria failed at 11 PM.'

Group MDM was waiting for Bulgaria MDM.

Since Bulgaria MDM failed — Group MDM never triggered.

PostgreSQL helps you trace the dependency chain.

### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"PostgreSQL stores job dependency rules and runtime information  
for all our batch pipelines.*

When investigating why a job didn't trigger,  
I query PostgreSQL to check the dependency chain —  
which upstream job failed and caused the downstream job to wait.

For example — if Group MDM didn't run,  
I check PostgreSQL to see which Local MDM job failed,  
because Group MDM depends on all Local MDMs completing successfully."

## How Teradata Connects

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

Teradata stores all the actual data — SDM, IDL, MDM.

When a job fails midway:

How many rows loaded before failure?

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM sdm.customer_accounts  
WHERE load_date = '2024-01-15';
```

What does the data look like at failed point?

```
SELECT * FROM sdm.customer_accounts  
WHERE load_date = '2024-01-15'  
AND country_code = 'BG' LIMIT 10;
```

Space management:

If Teradata space fills up — jobs fail mid-load.

I monitored and optimized space allocation.

Improved processing speed by 25%.

Reconciliation queries:

```
SELECT country_code, SUM(balance), COUNT(*)  
FROM sdm.customer_accounts  
GROUP BY country_code;
```

### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Teradata is our main data storage platform —*

*SDM, IDL, and MDM layers all reside in Teradata.*

I use Teradata for failure analysis —

checking how many rows loaded before a job failed,  
investigating data quality at each layer,  
and running validation queries.

I also managed Teradata space allocation —

preventing space-related job failures  
and improving ETL processing speed by approximately 25%."

## How UAC / Orchestration Connects

### REAL EXAMPLE — UNDERSTAND THIS FIRST

UAC = the alarm clock and traffic controller for all batch jobs.

1000+ jobs run every day in a specific order.

UAC manages this entire sequence.

Example sequence:

6 AM — File arrival check job  
7 AM — Belgium staging load job  
7 AM — Bulgaria staging load job (runs in parallel)  
8 AM — INF layer processing (after all staging complete)  
9 AM — IDL processing  
10 AM — SDM load  
11 AM — Local MDMs  
6 PM — Group MDM (evening run)

If any job fails — UAC shows red.

Downstream jobs wait.

You investigate, fix, restart.

You use UAC dashboard every day to monitor all these jobs.

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"UAC is our orchestration tool that manages  
the scheduling and dependency of all 1000+ daily batch jobs.*

Each job has defined dependencies and time windows.  
UAC ensures jobs run in the correct sequence —  
country staging jobs run in parallel,  
then INF processing starts only after all staging completes,  
and Group MDM runs in the evening after all Local MDMs finish.

I monitor the UAC dashboard daily.  
Any job failure appears immediately.  
I investigate root cause and resolve within SLA."

## PART 5 — WHAT IF REPORTS NOT SENT ON TIME?

| Report            | Who Needs It             | What Happens If Late                                                                                                               |
|-------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Counterparty data | TALTA → Regulators       | Regulator has wrong picture of KBC's bank exposure. If another bank collapses that day, KBC's risk is unknown. Regulatory penalty. |
| RAY / Credit Risk | GCRD team                | KBC management cannot calculate credit risk position. Wrong lending decisions. Internal reporting failure.                         |
| SRB Reporting     | European Regulator (SRB) | Formal regulatory notice to KBC. Repeated delays = heavy fines. Regulatory sanctions.                                              |
| Local MDM         | Country local teams      | Country teams cannot complete their own regulatory submissions. Chain reaction of penalties across countries.                      |

| Report         | Who Needs It  | What Happens If Late                                                                                      |
|----------------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reconciliation | Finance teams | Month-end financial statements cannot be closed. Audit findings. Wrong financial reporting to regulators. |
| ICM data       | Regulators    | Intra-group financial flows unknown to regulator. Regulatory compliance failure.                          |

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"KBC is a regulated European bank.*

Every report we produce is a mandatory regulatory submission.

If we delay counterparty data — regulators don't know KBC's exposure to other banks. If any of those banks has a problem that day, regulators are working with wrong information. This triggers regulatory warnings and financial penalties.

If GCRD doesn't get credit risk data — KBC's risk management team cannot assess total credit exposure. Business decisions are made with incomplete information.

Essentially — our ETL pipelines are critical infrastructure for KBC's regulatory compliance. That is why 100% SLA compliance was non-negotiable in our project."

## PART 6 — ENHANCEMENT REQUESTS — WHAT KIND?

### Types of Enhancement Requests with Examples

| Type                | Real Example                                                | What You Did in Informatica                                                                                                            |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| New field added     | Regulator requires new field 'ESG_RISK_SCORE' from Jan 2025 | Added column to flat file source definition. Added to Expression transformation. Mapped to target table in Teradata.                   |
| New country added   | KBC acquires bank in Romania — now Romania sends files      | Configured new file path in Putty. Created new Informatica source definition for Romania file. Added Romania to all processing layers. |
| File format change  | Bulgaria changed date format from DD/MM/YYYY to YYYY-MM-DD  | Updated flat file definition in Informatica. Updated TO_DATE conversion in Expression transformation.                                  |
| New report required | SRB requires new quarterly submission from 2025             | Analyzed new report requirements. Created new Informatica mapping for new data flow. Tested end to end.                                |
| Performance issue   | Group MDM taking 5 hours instead of 2                       | Checked session log for bottleneck. Optimized Teradata queries. Tuned Informatica buffer settings.                                     |

| Type                 | Real Example                              | What You Did in Informatica                                                              |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Business rule change | Credit rating calculation formula changed | Modified Expression transformation logic. Updated NVL handling. Tested with sample data. |

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"Enhancement requests in our project came from three sources:*

First — regulatory changes.

European regulators update reporting requirements periodically.

For example, when a new data field was mandated,

I modified the Informatica source definitions, transformation logic, and target table mappings to include it.

Second — business team requests.

New country onboarding, new report types, business rule changes.

For example, when a new country was added,

I configured the file ingestion, created new mappings, and added the country to all processing layers.

Third — performance improvements.

When jobs slowed down due to volume growth,

I optimized Teradata queries and Informatica session settings."

## PART 7 — COMPLETE INTERVIEW ANSWER

### End to End — Say This in Interview

#### SAY THIS IN INTERVIEW

*"I work on the KBC Rainbow project at Cognizant.*

KBC is a Belgian banking group with operations across multiple European countries — Belgium, Bulgaria, Hungary, Slovakia, and others.

Our team manages the ETL data pipeline that consolidates financial data from all these country branches for regulatory reporting.

Every day and month, local country teams send financial data files — customer account data, credit data, counterparty data, insurance data — via SFTP to our server.

I use Putty to connect and verify all files arrived correctly.

Data flows through multiple layers:

Landing — files stored raw as received.

Staging — data loaded into database tables as-is.

INF layer — Informatica PowerCenter processes data here.

Transformations applied: date standardization, NULL handling, currency conversion, reference data lookup, data routing.

IDL layer — data from all countries standardized to same format.

SDM in Teradata — clean data stored centrally.

Local MDM — each country gets their clean master data back.

Group MDM — evening run combining all countries at group level.

Counterparty processing happens in Group MDM — data about other banks KBC deals with is consolidated and sent to TALTA team for regulatory submission.

Monthly we run RAY process — collecting credit data from all countries and sending to GCRD — Group Credit Risk Data team — for credit risk assessment.

We also handle SRB regulatory reporting, ICM internal credit market data, sector reporting, and monthly reconciliation.

For job monitoring — UAC and Orchestration tools manage 1000+ daily batch jobs. PostgreSQL tracks job dependencies and runtime. Teradata stores all data and I use it for failure analysis. Informatica handles all ETL transformation logic.

If we don't deliver on time — KBC faces regulatory penalties because these are mandatory submissions to European banking regulators. For example, late counterparty data means regulators have wrong picture of KBC's exposure to other banks.

My role involved managing these pipelines, investigating failures, enhancing Informatica mappings, validating data at each layer, and ensuring all regulatory reports delivered within SLA."

## PART 8 — QUESTIONS INTERVIEWER WILL ASK

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### Basic Questions They Will Ask You

| Question                            | What They Want to Know                 | Your Key Answer Point                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tell me about yourself              | Your background and experience summary | 5 years, Cognizant, Mattel + KBC Rainbow, ETL enhancement and operations                                 |
| What is your current project?       | Understand your domain and work        | KBC Rainbow — banking ETL pipeline — regulatory reporting for European bank                              |
| What does your team do?             | Business context understanding         | Collect country financial data, process through ETL layers, deliver regulatory reports                   |
| What kind of data do you work with? | Domain knowledge                       | Customer accounts, credit data, counterparty data, insurance data — banking regulatory data              |
| What tools do you use?              | Technical stack                        | Informatica PowerCenter, Teradata, PostgreSQL, UAC, Putty, Jira, Jenkins, Bitbucket                      |
| What is your daily routine?         | How you actually work                  | Check file arrivals in Putty, monitor UAC jobs, investigate failures, validate data, handle enhancements |
| How many people in your team?       | Team size context                      | Cross-functional team — ETL developers, DBAs, business analysts — say 8-12 people                        |
| What was your biggest challenge?    | Problem solving ability                | Managing 1000+ daily jobs under SLA pressure — Czech Republic onsite production issues                   |
| Why are you leaving?                | Motivation and honesty                 | Want to move from enhancement/operations to full ETL development on IICS cloud platform                  |
| What is your notice period?         | Joining timeline                       | Answer honestly — usually 60-90 days in India                                                            |

## Technical Questions They Will Ask

| Question                            | Your Answer in One Line                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What transformations have you used? | Source Qualifier, Expression, Lookup, Joiner, Router, Aggregator, Filter — all in KBC and Mattel mappings |
| How do you handle NULL values?      | NVL in Expression transformation. Test: COUNT WHERE col IS NULL after load.                               |
| What is session log?                | Informatica log showing rows read, rows written, rows rejected, and transformation-level errors           |
| How do you find missing records?    | MINUS/EXCEPT query between source and target. Also check reject table.                                    |
| What is incremental load?           | Loading only new/changed records using timestamp watermark. Tested in KBC Rainbow daily batch jobs.       |
| What is SCD Type 2?                 | Keep history — new row inserted with new value, old row expired with end_date                             |
| How do you validate large data?     | COUNT first, then SUM checksum, then sample spot check. MINUS only if discrepancy found.                  |

| Question                       | Your Answer in One Line                                                                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What is checksum validation?   | Compare SUM of numeric columns between source and target to detect value-level corruption              |
| How do you handle job failure? | Check UAC error → check Informatica session log → identify root cause → fix → validate → restart       |
| What is Lookup cache?          | Informatica caches lookup table in memory at session start. Stale if lookup updated after cache built. |

## FINAL TIPS — MOST IMPORTANT

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- Practice Part 7 — Complete Answer — out loud every day. This is your most important answer.
- When they ask 'what kind of data?' — say: customer accounts, credit data, counterparty data, insurance data — banking regulatory data.
- When they ask 'where do you load?' — say: Teradata SDM (Shared Data Mart) through multiple processing layers.
- When they ask 'what happens if late?' — say: regulatory penalties, compliance failure, wrong risk assessments for the bank.
- Always mention your numbers: 1000+ jobs, 100% SLA, 25% performance improvement, Czech Republic onsite.
- For Informatica questions — you know all transformations from your L2 work. Speak confidently.
- If you forget something in the middle of your answer — pause, take a breath, continue. Don't panic.

***This is YOUR project. You lived it every day. Just say it. All the best Keerthana! 😊***